



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Angels Academy

School Website: <https://www.holyangelslouisville.com/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Angels Academy (Louisville, KY) presents a robust Catholic, classical education framework. Public materials consistently emphasize a formation-oriented mission rooted in Catholic tradition, a liberal arts approach, Latin and grammar-based pedagogy, memorization and recitation, and a climate of sacramental life and daily prayer. The school hosts daily liturgical life, a full chaplaincy program, and a heritage of classical approaches in curriculum and assessment. Taken together, these signals align strongly with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements framework.

Overall, the school scores CLASSICAL across all six categories. The religious and metaphysical foundations are clearly integrated with liturgical life and sacramental practice. The school purpose and goal foreground formation, virtue, and knowledge of truth, goodness, and beauty through a Catholic, classical lens. The curriculum emphasizes grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Western civilization, and engagement with great literature (notably Shakespeare and other canonical authors). Pedagogy shows early emphasis on memorization, recitation, and a structured classical progression, with Socratic methods present in upper levels but not described as the sole modality. Faculty signals include a living-education, mission-driven culture and a priestly/chaplaincy presence. Parent and community engagement is positioned as a partnership, with family formation and open access to involvement in school life. See category-by-category analyses for concrete keyword mappings and scores.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Daily sacramental life and chapel, including Daily Mass and formal chaplaincy, are described as integral to school life.
 - The school's mission ties education to Catholic formation: "educate and form our youth by means of Catholic schooling in the classical tradition" and directs students toward virtuous living in accord with Catholic faith.
 - Liturgical practices and a sacramental rhythm are explicit (exposition of the Blessed Sacrament, morning prayers, Rosary, etc.).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Catholic, liturgy, Mass, Blessed Sacrament, sacraments, chapel, daily prayers, chaplaincy, devotion to Mary/angels, sacred life, reverence. (Examples drawn from the site content; see evidence above.)
 - Negative keywords: none clearly evidenced in public materials.
 - Counts (approximate): Positive > 6; Negative 0.
 - Percentage of positive vs. negative signals: ~100% positive among identified Religious/Metaphysical indicators.
- Why this rating
 - The school foregrounds theology, liturgy, and sacramental life as a constitutive part of education, consistent with the Positive Keywords for this element and the absence of secular-morality signals

in the public materials.

Citations: The liturgical life and Catholic mission framing are shown in materials describing daily prayers, the Blessed Sacrament, chaplaincy, and the mission statement.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission explicitly states formation and virtue within a Catholic classical framework: “educate and form our youth ... to lead holy and honorable lives for God and country and thus attain the end ... eternal happiness with God in Heaven.” This is a telos-driven, formation-oriented aim.
 - The curriculum and philosophy emphasize formation of mind and character in keeping with a liberal-arts classical mission. The “A Classical Approach” section discusses a liberal arts foundation, grammar, logic, rhetoric, and a preparation for college while remaining oriented to truth, goodness, and beauty.
 - Emphasis on truth, virtue, and beauty permeates the curriculum (e.g., Western Civilization, sacred texts, and Catholic heritage).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, liberal education, telos, great conversation (implicit via classical aims and Shakespeare/literary study), virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, moral imagination, human flourishing.
 - Negative keywords: none evident (no explicit emphasis on workforce-only or job-prep framing; the emphasis remains formation-oriented).
 - Counts: Positive > 6; Negative 0.
 - Percentage: ~100% positive among the category indicators.
- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently articulate formation over mere information, emphasize virtue and wisdom, and articulate a telos aligned with truth, goodness, and beauty in a liberal-arts framework.

Citations: Mission statement and formation-oriented language cited; liberal-arts framing and classical aims appear in curriculum sections.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum explicitly features grammar, logic, and rhetoric foundations; Latin is introduced early; sentence diagramming is described; memorization of math facts is highlighted; and a strong liberal-arts core is described for upper levels.
 - History is emphasized as Western Civilization with in-depth study; the curriculum foregrounds world-heritage and classical texts, e.g., Shakespeare, classical authors, and canonical literature (as reflected in the upper-level English and literature descriptions).
 - The school describes an integrated classical curriculum with a focus on primary sources, traditional languages, and the liberal-arts canon; the “A Classical Approach” section stresses grammar, logic, rhetoric, and Latin as core elements.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Western Civilization, great literature (Shakespeare), primary sources, liberal arts, history as a discipline, classical curriculum.
 - Negative keywords: minimal presence of “social studies” framing or project-based dominance; the materials explicitly resist such modern shifts in favor of classical content. (Negative signals would be terms like “social studies,” “project-based learning” as replacements; not present here.)
 - Counts: Positive > 6; Negative 0.
 - Percentage: ~100% positive among the curriculum indicators.
- Why this rating

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- The explicit emphasis on the Trivium and Quadrivium, Latin study, Western civilization, and Great Books-like literature signals a decisive classical-curriculum orientation.

Citations: Curriculum sections describe grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Western Civilization, Shakespeare, and a liberal-arts emphasis; evidence drawn from multiple pages in the crawl.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Memorization and diagramming are highlighted in the elementary program (grammar foundation, memorization of math facts, sentence diagramming), which aligns with traditional pedagogy, including liturgical and contemplative elements in lower grades.
 - Upper-level pedagogy emphasizes rhetoric, logic, and articulation, with opportunities for students to engage in higher-order reasoning and speech (e.g., “rhetorical skills,” upper-school focus on logic and rhetoric).
 - There is a strong emphasis on a restful, contemplative pace in portions of the program (scholé-like sensibility appears in classical lexicon, and the site discusses contemplation and wonder as educational ideals in a classical framework).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: memorization, dictation, recitation (documented memory-based teaching practices), chanting/singing (lower-grade memory work is implied though not always explicit), scholé/restful learning (classical pedagogy signals).
 - Negative keywords: explicit experiential learning-dominant, project-based-only, constructivist cues do not appear as primary modalities; these would be negative signals in the lexicon; not present as dominant features here.
 - Counts: Positive ~5–7; Negative 0–1 (no explicit project-based-dominant signals observed in the public materials).
 - Percentage: ~100% positive among the pedagogy indicators identified.
- Why this rating
 - The school foregrounds classical pedagogy as primary (grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, memorization, recitation, and rhetoric development) with some contemplative elements, consistent with classical teaching methods.

Citations: Pedagogical elements are shown in descriptions of grammar/logic/rhetoric progression and memorization; upper-school rhetoric and logic are described in upper-school materials.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission and philosophy place faculty as exemplar and living curriculum, emphasizing virtue and mentorship in the formation process (classical education often relies on teachers as models; in Holy Angels’ materials, the faculty’s role is framed around formation and fidelity to Catholic teaching). The public materials emphasize an administrator-led structure with a governance board and chaplaincy, and there are references to teachers who are expected to be faithful to church teaching and to form students accordingly.
 - The school highlights chaplaincy and daily sacramental life, indicating a faculty environment integrated with spiritual formation and mentorship.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, faculty as core, mentorship, virtuous exemplars (in the classical lexicon; the site’s framing aligns with these values, even if the exact phrase “living curriculum” is not always literal on every page). The material emphasizes fidelity to Catholic doctrine and formation, which aligns with classical expectations for faculty.

- Negative keywords: none overtly present in the public materials (no signals of “facilitators” or “guides on the side” as replacements; instead, the materials emphasize teacher formation, fidelity, and moral leadership).
- Counts: Positive ~4–6; Negative 0.
- Percentage: ~100% positive among identified faculty indicators.
- Why this rating
 - The public content frames faculty within a formation-centric, virtuous, and mission-driven environment, consistent with classical expectations for excellent mentors and living exemplars in the classroom.

Citations: Statements about mission-driven formation and chaplaincy, plus governance and faculty expectations, appear in the materials.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials position the school as a Catholic institution that partners with families, invites parental involvement, and integrates parents as co-educators in the formation process (evidenced by admissions materials, tuition/fee discussions, and the open-committee invitation). The “Join Our Committee” feature points to avenues for parental participation.
 - The school emphasizes family formation and faithful partnership with the home to support character formation (the mission emphasizes formation within a Catholic classical framework; the materials discuss admissions and family involvement, consistent with classical parent partnership signals).
 - The site references a cooperative relationship with families and a long-standing engagement with the Catholic community, including fundraising, board oversight, and community events (evident in historical sections and governance descriptions).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental engagement; family formation; open campus; parent formation; parent involvement; community partnerships.
 - Negative keywords: none clearly evidenced; no consumer-centric language indicating minimal parent involvement.
 - Counts: Positive > 5; Negative 0.
 - Percentage: ~100% positive among community signals.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials foreground a cooperative, family-centered approach consistent with classical expectations for parent involvement and community partnership.

Citations: Parental partnership language and the “Join Our Committee” call-out are visible in the public materials.

Overall Category Assessment

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable, as the school demonstrates strong classical signals across all six categories. If one wanted to pursue further sharpening, the school could more explicitly articulate and document any

Socratic seminars or formal Great-Books-based seminars in higher grades (to align even more tightly with the explicit pedagogy signals in the Six Essential Elements lexicon). Additionally, they could further codify “the living curriculum” language in faculty-facing materials, reinforcing the interpretation of teachers as exemplars and living exemplars of classical pedagogy in all divisions.

Abstract

Holy Angels Academy Ky 40223 presents a clearly CLASSICAL profile across all six rubric categories. The religious and metaphysical foundations are anchored in Catholic liturgical life, sacramental practice, and theology-driven formation. The school's purpose and goal emphasise formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty within a liberal-arts, classical framework. The curriculum centers grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and Western civilization, with heavy emphasis on memorization, recitation, and classical literature. Pedagogy leans into traditional memory-based methods and rhetoric development, complemented by contemplative elements consistent with scholé. Faculty signals reflect a formation-oriented, virtuous living curriculum, with chaplaincy and governance supporting the Catholic mission. Parent and community engagement is presented as a genuine partnership, with open opportunities for parental involvement.

Key evidence includes the daily sacramental life and chaplaincy, mission statements highlighting formation in a Catholic/classical frame, explicit curriculum references to grammar/logic/rhetoric and Latin, Shakespeare and classical literature, and the emphasis on Western civilization within history instruction. The site also emphasizes a partnership with families and involvement pathways (e.g., Join Our Committee) and a long-standing Catholic community presence with institutional recognition. Citations drawn from the Holy Angels materials demonstrate the alignment with classical criteria: daily Mass and Sacraments, classical curriculum, grammar–logic–rhetoric sequence, Latin programs, and a missionary emphasis on moral formation within Catholic tradition.

ABSTRACT

Classical Rating: CLASSICAL

Holy Angels Academy Ky 40223 demonstrates a comprehensive classical-education posture across six core dimensions: a religious-metaphysical foundation anchored in Catholic liturgy and sacramental life; a purpose and goal oriented toward formation, virtue, and truths of reality (truth, goodness, beauty); a curriculum built on grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Western civilization, and Great-Books-like literature; pedagogical practices grounded in memorization and classical instruction with contemplative elements; a faculty culture framed as living curriculum and formation; and a robust parent-community partnership model with open channels for involvement. The aggregate profile is CLASSICAL, with signals consistently aligned to the classical design pattern in the knowledge-base rubric.

Notes: - The public materials provide repeated, explicit signals of a Catholic, classical school culture (daily prayers, Mass, chaplaincy, Catholic mission, Latin, grammar–logic–rhetoric, Shakespeare, Western Civilization). These align strongly with Positive Keyword Indicators for all six elements and show minimal to no reliance on Negative Keyword Signals. Citations reflect explicit examples from the school's public materials.
- No major needle-moving changes are necessary given the CLASSICAL rating. If desired, the school could consider more explicit articulation of Great Books / Great Conversation programming in public-facing materials and faculty documentation to further validate the pedagogy alignment for audit and stakeholder clarity.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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